Advising Center Frequently Asked Questions

How do I find out who my Adviser is?

Log in to LionPath and on your Home Screen, towards the bottom of the page, you will see "My Adviser". If there is no one listed, you have not been assigned an adviser yet. All first-year students will be assigned an adviser within the first few weeks of the semester. Contact the Advising Center if you have not been assigned an adviser after the first few weeks.

What's the difference between a professional Adviser and a faculty adviser?

As a first- or second-year student, your intended major will determine whether your adviser is a professional or faculty member. Professional advisers are located in the Advising Center, 220 Sutherland, and are well qualified to help you reach your academic goals. They advise mainly first- and second-year students. Faculty advisers usually advise students already in majors, but in some cases, they advise students heading toward specific majors within a college. Faculty advisers deal mostly with issues directly related to specific majors, whereas professional advisers usually work with students deciding among many possible majors.

Do my cumulative Credits include courses in which I've earned an "F"?

Cumulative credits include the number of credits scheduled at Penn State for a letter grade, even if a final grade of an "F" is earned.

How do I find out what requirements I need to fulfill in order to graduate?

If you have been accepted into a major, log in to LionPath and click on on the "hamburger" icon on the top left corner of the screen. Then select "Academics" and Academic Requirements.

If you have not yet been accepted into a major or you are exploring different majors and want to see how your credits apply, log in to LionPath, click on the "hamburger" icon on the top left corner of the screen and select "What-If Report". Use this step-by-step video to run a "**What-If Report**" **https://tutorials.lionpath.psu.edu/public/S_RunningWhatifReport**

How and when can I Drop and/or add a course?

Courses can be added and/or dropped during the regular Drop/Add period, which is during the first week of the semester. You can drop courses through Saturday at 11:59 p.m. at the end of the first week of classes. You can add courses through Sunday at 8:00 a.m. after the first week of classes.

On Monday of the second week of classes, the Late Drop period begins. It runs from the eleventh day of the semester to the end of the twelfth week of the semester. Courses can be late dropped but not added during this period. If a course is dropped during the Late Drop period, it will show up on your transcript as "LD". Contact your adviser before late-dropping a course because there may be financial aid ramifications depending on individual student situations.

Part-time students (taking fewer than 12 credits) will be assessed a tuition penalty for dropping or adding during the Late Drop period. See **http://www.bursar.psu.edu/adjustments.cfm** for details.

What is an Early Progress Report?

First-year students and first-semester transfer students who are doing poorly in a course during the third to sixth week of a semester may receive an Early Progress Report detailing the reasons for their poor performance. If you receive an Early Progress Report in a course, you should talk with the professor about how to improve your performance in the course.

How do I find out the Entrance to Major requirements for any major?

Go to the **Academic Advising Portal**, Entry to Major requirements page. Choose the college and then the major you're interested in. To find out which college a major is in, go to University Bulletin: Course Descriptions, Four- and Two-Year Degrees.

What do I do if I find that I am failing some or all my classes?

Contact your adviser to discuss your options.

I am getting poor Grades in one or more courses. What should I do?

Set up a meeting with your professor as well as a separate meeting with your professional adviser. They will be able to help you get back on track in your courses and connect you with campus resources.

How can I learn more about Internships?

There are two kinds of internships: professional and exploratory. Professional internships are required in a major; check your Academic Requirements or What-If Report to see if an internship course is required; it will be numbered 495 in a major discipline, e.g., PSYCH 495 or B A 495. Exploratory internships are voluntary and may be done in connection with any major. For more information about internships, contact your adviser in your major and/or The Center for Career and Professional Development, which is on the second floor of Lares.

What do I have to do to take a Leave of absence?

Learn more at the **leave of absence webpage**.

How and when do I declare a Major?

Your professional adviser will be sending you Academic Reviews at the end of each semester, reminding you of upcoming responsibilities. Depending on your major of interest, you will be able to enter your major as early as Fall semester of your sophomore year. Please meet with your professional adviser to ensure that you are on track to declare your major in a timely, efficient fashion.

How do I change my Major?

If you have already declared a major and would like to change it, please set up an appointment with a professional adviser to ensure you are going to complete the degree in an appropriate time frame.

How and when do I declare a Minor?

A minor can be declared after you attain **third-semester classification** or after you have been accepted into a major. The procedures for entering a minor depend on whether the minor has entry requirements:

1. Minors that do not have entrance requirements can be declared using Lionpath, **Update Academics**
2. Minors that have special entrance criteria (e.g., prerequisite courses, a portfolio, an audition) require an application (see Special Considerations listed by minor in the **University Bulletin**. Students applying for a minor with entrance criteria should meet with the faculty contact provided in information about the minor.

How and when do I declare a second, or “double Major”?

Double majors are called “concurrent majors” at Penn State. After you are in a major, you must submit an Application for Approval of Concurrent Majors form to declare your intent to complete a concurrent major to the department or division of your first major.

What Majors can I complete at Abington?

See our **Abington majors**.

How do I move from Non-degree (NDEGR) status to degree status?

If you have been a degree student and then became a nondegree student, you must earn at least a 2.00 CGPA (cumulative grade point average) by the time you complete 40 credits in NDEGR status. As soon as you have a 2.00 CGPA, submit a Reenrollment form in the Scheduling Office, 121 Sutherland.

How do I register for an Online course (World Campus, eLearning, Independent Learning, Correspondence, or Distance Education)?

World Campus courses are listed in the online Schedule of Courses. If there are seats available in a course you want, contact World Campus’s Adult Learner Enrollment Services at 800 252-3592 and select option 1.

In general, you will not be able to schedule the course(s) until one week before the start date of the class. There also are some courses that are restricted to world campus students. Contact **wdregistration@outreach.psu.edu** for more information.

What is a Prerequisite course?

A prerequisite course is one that must be completed before taking another course. You should not try to take a course that has prerequisites without having completed all them first. Prerequisite requirements are to be taken seriously; they help you from enrolling in a course in which you cannot possibly do well.

However, if you believe you have the knowledge that the prerequisite course provides and feel able to handle the course for which it is a prerequisite, you should talk with the instructor of the course for which you have not met the prerequisite.

The instructor should be able to judge whether or not it's appropriate for you to take the course. If the instructor is not inclined to allow you to take the course, you should respect the instructor's judgment. If you enroll in a course for which you have not met the prerequisites, you may be disenrolled at the request of the instructor

When can I Register?

Your Registration Dates appear on your LionPath homepage. Once the Registration Dates become available, you will see a date to fill your Shopping Cart and a date to officially register.

What is Academic Renewal?

Academic Renewal is taking up your Penn State academic career after having spent four years away from the University. Existing courses in which you earned less than a C grade are separated from other courses, which remain in place on your degree audit. Your cumulative grade point average (CGPA) is reset to 0.0, which makes it easier for you to succeed.

If I Repeat a course that I earned "D" or "F" in and got a better grade, will the "D" or "F" grade be replaced by the better grade?

Beginning with the summer 2020 semester, Penn State is implementing a new grade forgiveness option for undergraduate students. Under this new policy, if a student earns a D or F grade in a course but then repeats the course and earns a better grade, the original grade can be forgiven. If a grade forgiveness request is approved, the original course still will appear on the student's official transcript, but will not earn credit or count towards the student's term or

cumulative GPA. More information can be found here: http://www.registrar.psu.edu/grades/grade-forgiveness.cfm

How can I learn more about Study Abroad?

Learn more about **Penn State Abington's study abroad**.

How do I change my campus to University Park or to another Penn State location (Change of Assignment)?

If you are transitioning to University Park, you will need to be accepted into a major before changing your campus. You may be able to transition to another Penn State campus without first being accepted into a major, but you should consult your Academic Adviser before making any adjustments to your campus assignment.

What is Academic Warning?

Can I Withdraw from the University?

Contact your adviser or go to the Scheduling Office, 121 Sutherland, to complete a Withdrawal form. All your courses for that semester will be canceled. You will receive a W on your transcript for those courses. You must withdraw from a semester no later than the last day of classes.

How do I Withdraw from the University?

Contact your adviser or go to the Scheduling Office, 121 Sutherland, to complete a Withdrawal form. You can also withdraw through eLion. All your courses for that semester will be cancelled. You will receive a W on your transcript for those courses. You must withdraw from a semester no later than the last day of classes.

How do I Transfer a course from another college and/or university to Penn State?

First, go to the **Transfer Evaluation Guide** to see if the course is accepted by Penn State. It is recommended that you meet with your Academic Adviser before registering for a course at another institution.

Transferring courses into the major requirements areas of your degree audit can only be done once you are in a major. In order for courses to be transferred to Penn State, you must have the other college or university send your official transcript to:

Penn State Admissions
201 Shields Building
University Park, PA 16802

Note: The final grade of the course must be a "C" or higher in order to transfer. Also, grades of transfer credits do not count towards your GPA.

How do I request a new adviser?

Please fill out the **Adviser Request Form** and someone from the Advising Office will be in touch in about a week with more information. Make sure to check your PSU email.

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PennState University Registrar

Adding, Dropping, and Auditing Courses

Registration is a continuous process at Penn State, beginning with the student's first day to register and continuing until the first day of classes for the semester. Once the semester begins, the process of changing the student's course schedule is referred to as dropping/adding courses (policy 34-87 and policy 34-89). Before registering or making any registration changes consult with your academic adviser.

Adding Courses

Before registering or making any registration changes consult with your academic adviser.

Adding a Course During Regular Add Period

The period of time at the start of each course when the course can be added without incurring a $6 late drop/add fee.

- The add period for full-semester courses ends at 11:59 p.m. ET on the seventh day of the fall/spring semester and is a calculated proportional length for all other courses.
- No permission(s) required
- No fee

Process to Add a Course During Regular Add Period:

1. Obtain the Class Number from the Schedule of Courses.
2. In the LionPATH Student Center, click the "Enrollment" tab and then "Add Classes", and select the term for enrollment.
   - Read Instructions on How to Add Courses in LionPATH
3. In person using a Registration Add Form. Submit the form to the department offering the course, the advising center or the Registrar's office.

Adding a Credit Overload

Adding a course that will take a student over 19 credits for the semester.

- Beginning Fall 2023, will result in a tuition surcharge
- Cannot process until the first day of classes
- Approval of the adviser is recommended
- $6.00 fee for each transaction after the regular add period

Process to Add a Credit Overload:

1. Obtain the Class Number from the Schedule of Courses.
2. In the LionPATH Student Center, click the "Enroll" link under Academics, and then choose the "Add" subtab to add a course.
   - Read Instructions on How to Add Courses in LionPATH
3. In person using a Registration Drop/Add Form. Submit the form to the department offering the course or the Registrar's office.

Effective Spring 2022, students who have a cumulative grade point average of at least 2.0 can enroll for up to 24 credits.

Adding a Course that is Departmentally Controlled

The department has restricted registration, department approval to add the course must be obtained.

- Department approval required
- $6.00 fee for each transaction after the regular add period

Process to Add a Course that is Departmentally Controlled:

1. Obtain the Class Number from the Schedule of Courses.
2. In person using a Registration Drop/Add Form. Submit the form to the department offering the course.

Late Adding a Course

Adding a course after the regular add period ends.

- Permission is required, must obtain signature of the course instructor
- $6.00 fee for each course added

Process to Late Add a Course:

1. Obtain the Class Number from the Schedule of Courses.
2. In person using a drop/add form, must have instructor signature.
3. For courses at University Park, contact the department offering the course. For courses at non-University Park locations, contact the appropriate campus registrar's office.

Dropping Courses

There are financial implications to consider when dropping courses. Tuition penalties may apply and financial aid may be impacted. Students who receive financial aid are strongly encouraged to consult with the Office of Student Aid.

Students who require course drops due to military leave, please follow the instructions on the Military Leave of Absence, Military Withdrawal and Military Drop page.

Dropping a Course During Regular Drop Period

The period of time at the start of each course when the course can be dropped without incurring a $6 drop/add fee. Dropping a course during this time means that:

- Length of drop period is 6 calendar days during fall/spring for full-semester courses and is a calculated proportional length for all other courses.
- No permission(s) required.
- No fee

Process to Drop a Course During Regular Drop Period:

There are two ways in which a student can drop a course:

- In the LionPATH Student Center, click the "Enrollment" tab and then "Drop Classes", and select the current term of enrollment.

- Read Instructions on How to Drop Courses in LionPATH

- In person using a Registration Drop/Add Form. Submit the form to the department offering the course or the Registrar's office.

Late Dropping a Course

Dropping a course after the regular drop period and before the late drop deadline, (policy 34-89). A student can drop a course with certain restrictions and requirements. They are:

- No permission(s) required
- $6.00 fee for each course dropped
- Courses are recorded on the student record

Process to Late Drop a Course:

There are two ways in which a student can late drop a course:

- In the LionPATH Student Center, click the "Enroll" link under Academics, and then choose the "Drop" subtab to a course.
  - Read Instructions on How to Drop Courses in LionPATH
- In person using a Registration Drop/Add Form. Submit the form to the department offering the course, the advising center or the Registrar's office.

Auditing Courses

If a student wishes to register for a course without earning a letter grade or credit, the course may be taken as an audit (policy 34-68, 48-80).

Auditing a Course

- Must be processed prior to the semester/session or during the add period for the course.
- No permission(s) required.
- Course will appear on the student's schedule as though it has been scheduled for credit.
- The course will appear on the student's transcript with the grading symbol "AUS" if attendance was satisfactory or "AUU" if the attendance was unsatisfactory.
- No credit is earned, and the grade-point average is not affected.
- A course may be dropped for credit and added for audit or dropped for audit and added for credit by undergraduate students only during the drop and add periods for the course.
- Credits for a course being audited are not counted in determining the following:
  - full-time status for undergraduate students
  - enrollment status (full-time or part-time) for graduate students
  - calculating semester standing
  - financial aid status
  - full-time status for international students for reporting to SEVIS (Student Exchange Visitor Information System) under federal requirements.

Process to Audit a Course:

1. In person using a Registration Drop/Add Form.

2. Write "AU" in place of credits on the form.

3. Submit the form to the Registrar's office.

Faculty Advising Resources

Faculty - do you have an Advising Question? Please use this form.

What is ALEKS?

The ALEKS Math Assessment ensures students' readiness for particular math, statistics, and chemistry courses at Penn State. Since these courses are demanding, it is important for students to begin in the course most likely to lead to success. Students will not be permitted to take a course unless they have demonstrated readiness. After completing the initial assessment, students who wish to improve their skills may use the included learning modules.

Who must take ALEKS?

Beginning in spring 2021, first-year and transfer students admitted to any campus except World Campus who completed calculus in high school will automatically place into the 76-100 ALEKS placement band. The LionPATH Academic Background will show a dummy ALEKS score of 101.

All entering first-year students who do not have calculus on their admissions record will be required to complete ALEKS in order to schedule a course that requires placement as a pre-requisite. Students will be instructed to complete the ALEKS

assessment prior to attending their NSO program by multiple official NSO communications.

All entering first-year students, regardless of their high school calculus experience, have automatic access to ALEKS.

Students beginning classes in Spring semester may begin the assessment November 1. Students beginning classes in Summer and Fall semesters may begin the assessment March 1.

New transfer students who do not have calculus on their admission record may be directed to take the ALEKS assessment by their academic adviser using the following guidelines:

Students who have not taken a college level math course should be directed to take ALEKS. Advisers must initiate request for access*.
Students whose transfer courses have been transcribed as equivalent to PSU courses will use those courses to meet prerequisites.
All other students intending to take a math course should work through the campus-specific procedure for pre-requisite overrides.

When do students take ALEKS?

Students need to demonstrate readiness for their scheduled courses via ALEKS assessment prior to the start of classes. Students beginning classes in Spring semester may begin the assessment November 1. Students beginning classes in Summer and Fall semesters may begin the assessment March 1.

What are the Deadlines for Testing?

Students will not be able to register for math courses in LionPATH unless they have the appropriate ALEKS placement test score or transfer credits for the pre-requisite course.

How will transfer courses impact ALEKS placement?

Math course(s) transferred from accredited colleges and universities and evaluated by Penn State as:

A direct equivalent to a PSU math course, entered on a student's transcript with a specific Penn State course number, i.e., MATH 021 TR, MATH 140 TR, etc., will override ALEKS placement.

A general equivalent, entered on a student's transcript as MATH GEN, will require the student to complete ALEKS placement to verify their appropriate Math placement at Penn State.

No separate chemistry placement test:

Many science, engineering, and health-focused programs require CHEM 110. CHEM 110 is a rigorous course involving significant mathematical manipulation and algebra proficiency. Chemistry placement will be based on previous exposure to chemistry in high school, the results of any honors or AP chemistry exams, and performance on the ALEKS Math Assessment.

Students who do not have previous chemistry studies, should begin with CHEM 101, since CHEM 110 is not an introductory course. If students have gaps in math and/or chemistry preparation, they will need additional preparation before taking CHEM 110.

Information on concurrent majors (double majors):

Two programs--concurrent majors and sequential majors--allow a baccalaureate or associate degree candidate to earn degrees in more than one Penn State major. When completing concurrent majors, the student simultaneously completes all

academic requirements for his/her majors and graduates with two (or more) degrees in the same semester.

Click here for more info on the policy and procedures for approval.

English 202 A or B or C or D?

There are four different types of English 202 classes: English 202A, English 202B, English 202C, and English 202D.

- At Abington, enrollment in one of these courses is often restricted to students in their fourth semester or higher.
- A student may take only one course for credit from ENGL 202A, 202B, 202C, and 202D.
- Students should be advised to base the specific type of English 202 class that they take on their major (or intended major).

English 202A: Writing in the Social Sciences. English 202B: Writing in the Humanities. English 202C: Technical Writing (for our Engineering and Science students, IST students can take English 202C or 202D). English 202D: Business Writing. If a student has not chosen a course wisely, he or she may find that they need to retake the appropriate section of English 202 for their major and will not receive credit for their first course that they took (non Abington majors).

What is the difference between CAS 100, 100A, 100B and 100c?

- At Abington, CAS 100 sections are usually taught off campus and are reserved for students in one of our continuing education programs.
- CAS 100A has an emphasis on public speaking & presentations.
- CAS 100B focuses on group problem solving & group presentations.
- Some campuses offer CAS 100C which involves message evaluation and analysis. CAS 100C is not offered at Abington at this time.

- Abington degree seeking students should choose between CAS 100A or CAS 100B based on their interests and skills.

Who are my advisees? How many advisees do I have? What are their GPA's? What is their semester standing?

If you would like to see a snapshot of your advising load you can do so in Starfish. Starfish also will allow you to download your current "advising roster" in excel. Students-> My students->Connection-> Assigned Adviser. Having this list saved in excel may be helpful at FAR time.

You also may use the "additional filters" feature in Starfish to look at specific groups of students such as filtering by Cumulative GPA or Semester Standing (Level).

How do I request a new adviser for one of my advisees?

Please fill out the **Adviser Change Form**. Someone will be in touch in about 5 business days.



Additional Resources

Faculty Advising Videos and Documents

Penn State Abington Faculty Advising Manual ›

Conducting Academic Reviews in Starfish ›

FACULTY ADVISING RESOURCES ›

Starfish Flags and Kudos-Early Progress Reports ›

Advising Syllabus ›

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